

Stranded eSports athletes

Left in the middle of nowhere

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Playing computer games for a living sounds pretty lucrative, right? Someone paying you and taking care of all your needs while you grind and clock in hours of gameplay and gain fans. Digging into a computer game, sounds no less than a dream. In today's world, it is a reality, and the top eSports athletes are getting all of it and sometimes, even more than the athletes of conventional sports. It is of course not easy as we are making it sound here, but you get the point. A career in eSports is a serious consideration for many. Still, as lovely as it may sound to write in your Twitter bio that you are a professional DOTA 2 player, there are perils attached to this profession that people seldom talk about.

You would have read several articles online and in print about the physical and mental stress eSports athletes go through. There's another set of problems that arise when in some cases, in the middle of a tournament, entire rosters of players are left without an organization/team to play for. Yes, it is

a real thing, and this issue plagues the world of eSports, especially at this time, where everywhere you look, there's nothing but uncertainty about what would hit you tomorrow. Will it be another variant of the notorious virus? Or will it be an explosive projectile? Being left hanging in the middle of nowhere without a team to play for or with is a problem that we want to cover here.

Of the names and regions

While it may have been years since players have represented teams, and what were called video games are now called eSports titles, there is still no guarantee for many players that they



Players from the former Gambit roster in plain jerseys at PGL Major Antwerp 2022 Europe RMR B

(Source: HLTV.org)

will have an organization backing them when they wake up the next day. This is not the case with every athlete out there, but even the best are not spared when the wind of doom comes their way. A recent example of this happening is the world's 3rd best team in Counter Strike: Global Offensive, Gambit (now Cloud9), and Virtus.Pro.

In the first week of March, when geopolitical instability hit the Eastern European region, two of the most